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Assignment-4 Information Theory and Coding

Q1. A code has minimum distance $d = 4$. Can it correct 2 errors?

Ans. Error correction capability:

$$t = (d - 1) / 2$$

Substitute $d = 4$:

$$t = (4 - 1) / 2 = (3 / 2) = 1$$

Conclusion:

It can correct only 1 error

Therefore, it cannot correct 2 errors

Q2. Code A ($d=3$) vs Code B ($d=5$):
Which is better?

Ans. Error correction capability:

- Code A: $t = (3 - 1) / 2 = 1$

- Code B: $t = (5 - 1) / 2 =$

2

#Conclusion:

- Code B is better
- It can correct more errors (2 vs 1)
- Higher reliability and noise tolerance

Q3. Claim: "If a code detects 3 errors, it can also correct 3 errors."

Ans. Error detection condition:

- To detect 3 errors: $d \geq 3 + 1$
- If it detects 3 errors: $d \geq 4$
- Correction capability:
- $t = (d - 1) / 2 = 1$

#Conclusion:

- It can detect 3 errors
- But can correct only 1 error
- Statement is false

Q4. (7,4) Hamming Code: Syndrome = 000. Is it always error-free?

Ans. Normal case:

Syndrome = 000 means no single-bit error detected

Edge

case:

Hamming code detects only single-bit errors

Two-bit errors may produce syndrome = 000

#Conclusion:

Not always error-free

Multiple-bit errors may go undetected

Q5. A code detects up to 2 errors. What is its minimum distance?

Ans. Detection condition:

$$d \geq s + 1$$

Given $s = 2$:

$$d \geq 3$$

#Conclusion:

Minimum distance = 3